Model Question Paper

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

(DSE)- MG5DSEENG308 – AFRICAN LITERATURES

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. In her lecture "The Danger of a Single Story" Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie argues that the primary problem with stereotypes is not that they are untrue, but that they are: [U]/[CO1]
   A) Intentional lies created by political regimes.
   B) Incomplete narratives that rob people of their dignity.
   C) Difficult to translate across different cultures.
   D) Only accessible to wealthy published authors.
2. The poem 'The Dead King Hunts and Eats The Gods' is taken from? [K]/[CO2]
   A) The Book of the Dead
   B) The Pyramid Texts
   C) The Coffin Texts
   D) The Amduat
3. What is said about the groom's drinking habit? [K]/[CO2]
   A) He drinks fresh milk
   B) He is inclined to live on stale local beer
   C) He drinks from salt lake
   D) He never drinks
4. According to Adichie, the concept of nkali(an Igbo word meaning "to be greater than another") directly influences storytelling by dictating: [K]/[CO1]
   A) Which languages stories must be translated into.
   B) The chronological order in which a plot unfolds.
   C) How stories are told, who tells them, when they are told and how many are told.
   D) The financial royalties an author receives from international publishers.

5. Ngugi wa Thiongo's novel Weep Not, Child is set against the historical backdrop of which major conflict in Kenyan history? [K]/ [CO3]
   A) The Anglo-Zulu War
   B) The Nigerian Civil War
   C) The Mau Mau Uprising
   D) The Algerian War of Independence
6. For the young protagonist Njoroge, western education initially serves as a symbol of: [U]/[CO3]
   A) A way to permanently his family and move to Europe.
   B) A messianic hope for self-advancement, land recovery, and national harmony.
   C) A modern burden forced upon him by his father, Ngotho.
   D) A tool to help white settlers like Mr. Howlands manage their farms.
7. In Agostinho Neto's poem "The Grieved Lands of Africa" what does the poetic imagery of "imperishable cry" and "the rhythm of life" signify? [An]/[CO4]
   A) The total despair and cultural erasure of African societies.
   B) The resilient, enduring, and triumphant spirit of Africa despite centuries of suffering.
   C) A call for immediate industrial modernization based on western models.
   D) A nostalgic lamentation for an ancient world that cannot be salvaged.
8. Leopold Sedar Senghor's poem "Black Woman" employs idealized imagery celebrating African beauty and heritage, making it a classic example of which movement? [K]/[CO4]
   A) Modernism
   B) Negritude
   C) Postmodernism
   D) Naturalism

9. The Cannibal Hymn is known as? [K]/[CO2]
   A) The newest written expression of African literature.
   B) The oldest written expression of African literary history
   C) A colonial text
   D) A medieval text
10. In the short story "The Collector of Treasures" Dikeledi's final act of violence against her husband , Garesego, is framed as a desperate response to: [U]/[CO4]
   A) A property dispute over traditional tribal lands.
   B) The systematic breakdown of marital responsibility and the abusive entitlement of patriarchal men.
   C) A political disagreement regarding local independence movements.
   D) An accidental misunderstanding over money sent for her children's schooling.

[1x10= 10]

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11. What does the author mean by a "single story," and how does it affect our understanding of a culture? [U]/[CO1]
12. What does the imagery of the dead king hunting and consuming gods signify about royal power in ancient myth? [An]/[CO2]
13. How does the relationship between Njoroge and his brother Kamau reflect changing hopes under colonial rule? [An]/[CO3]
14. What major societal pressures drive Dikeledi to commit her ultimate act of rebellion against her husband? [An]/[CO4]
15. What primary metaphors or symbols does Agostinho Neto use to convey the ongoing suffering of the African continent? [U]/[CO4]
16. In what ways does the Mau Mau uprising disrupt education and family life throughout the novel? [U]/[CO3]
17. How do the young singers use humour or lighthearted insults against the groom to subvert patriarchal expectations? [An]/[CO2]
18. What three near- impossible tasks does the Sky God demand from Anansi in exchange for ownership of all stories? [K]/[CO2]
19. What conflict arises for African writers who choose to write in European colonial languages instead of indigenous ones? [U]/[CO1]

[5x6=30]

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20. Analyze the character of Anansi the Spider as a classic West African trickster figure, focusing on how wit and deception serve as survival strategies against dominant powers. [An]/[CO2]
21. How does Ngugi wa Thiong'o use the disintegration of Njoroge's family in Weep Not, Child to mirror the psychological and political trauma inflicted on Kenya during the Mau Mau Emergency? [An]/[CO3]
22. Analyze the imagery of suffering and resilience in Agostinho Neto's poem "The Grieved Lands of Africa," focusing on how the text transforms collective grief into an anthem of resistance. [An]/[CO4]
23. Explain what Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie means by the phrase "the danger of a single story."How does she describe the way single stories are constructed, and what does she identify as their primary consequences? [U]/[CO1]

[15x2=30]